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Leaders

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echnology, unlike science, is a group activity. It is not based on individual intel igence, but on the interaction of many people. I think the biggest success of IGMDP is not the fact that in
record time the country acquired the capability of making five state-ofthe-art missile systems but that through it, some superb teams of scientists and engineers have been created. If someone asks me about my personal achievements in Indian rocketry, I would put it down to having created a chal enging environment for teams of young people to work in.

In their formative stages, teams are much like children in spirit. They are as excitable, as ful of vitality, enthusiasm, curiosity and the desire to please and excel. As with children, however, these positive attributes can be destroyed by the behaviour of misguided parents. For teams to be successful, the environment must offer scope for innovation. I confronted many such chal enges during the